

CANADA VS QATAR

Game-frame and data opposition report

MATCH LENS

Qatar can survive long periods without the ball, protect central lanes and release quickly through Akram Afif, wide runners and direct forward passes. Canada need early width, fast circulation and clean first passes after regain.



28.8%

POSSESSION

v Switzerland

0.52

XG

1 goal

6

SHOTS

3 SOT

47%

LOW BLOCK

OOP phase

294

PRESSURES

42 direct

PROJECTED LINEUPS & AVAILABILITY

Lineups based on current match reference and recent Qatar role usage.



CANADA AVAILABILITY

- Davies and Bombito unavailable in the supplied Canada context.
- Laryea at left-back and Johnston at right-back.
- Protect wide transition space without Davies/Bombito recovery speed.

QATAR AVAILABILITY / ROLE NOTES

- Akram Afif is the key connector and primary transition outlet.
- Qatar can show 4-2-3-1 in possession and defend in a deeper 4-5-1 / 5-3-2 block.
- Canada must protect central pockets and the first pass into Afif.

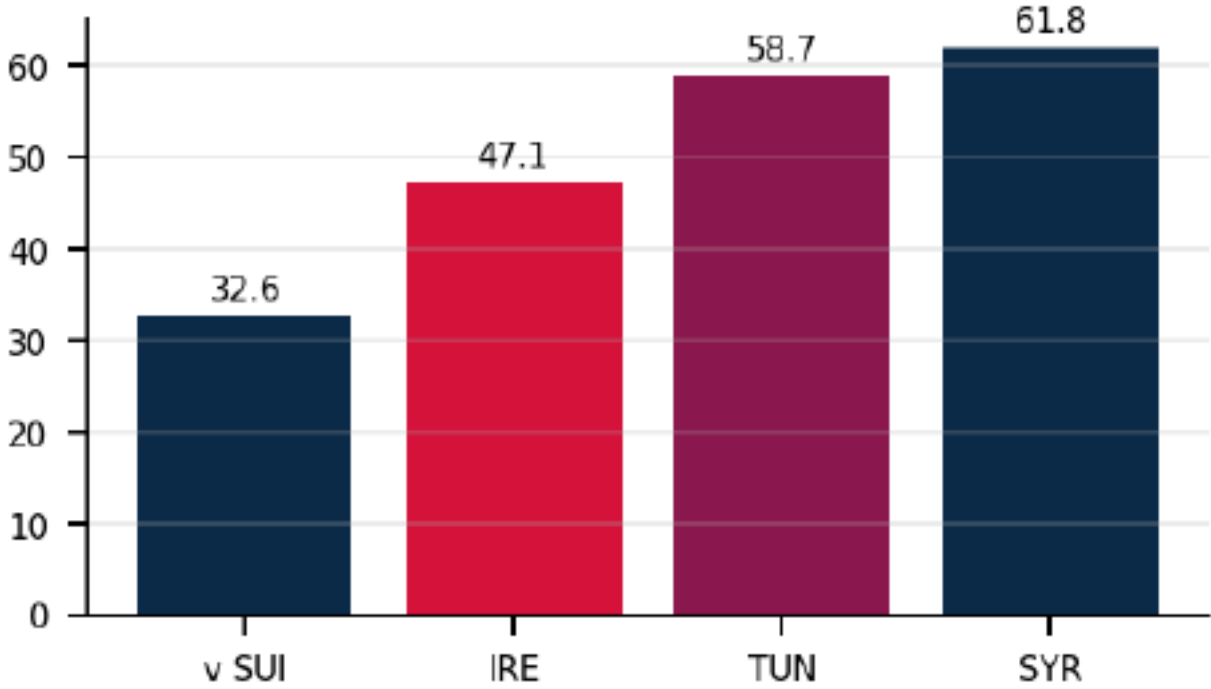
TEAM STRUCTURE & RECENT FORM

Recent Qatar sample, match output and phase profile.

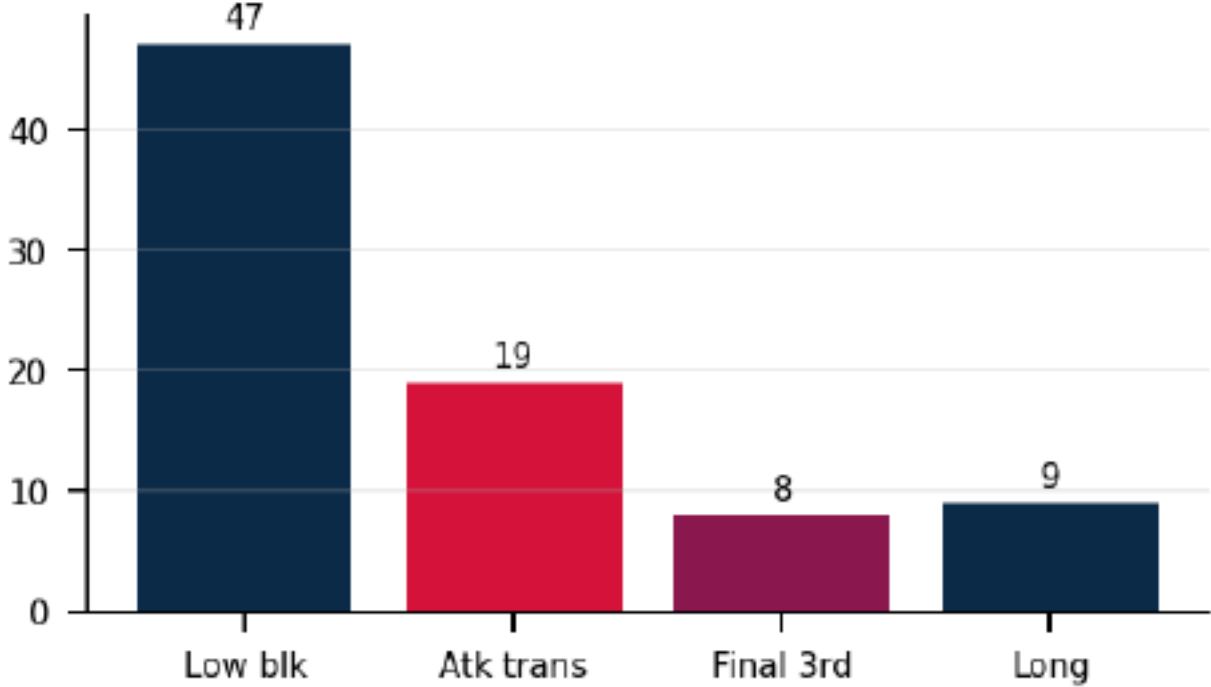
RECENT MATCH SAMPLE

Date	Match	Sch	G	xG	Sh	Poss
2026-06-13	Qatar v Switzerland 1:1	4-3-3	1	0.51	5	32.6%
2026-05-28	Republic of Ireland v Qatar 1:0	4-3-3	0	0.49	8	47.1%
2025-12-07	Qatar v Tunisia 0:3	4-2-3-1	0	1.00	12	58.7%
2025-12-04	Syria v Qatar 1:1	4-2-3-1	1	1.25	19	61.8%
2025-12-01	Qatar v Palestine 0:1	4-2-3-1	0	0.65	9	63.1%
2025-11-17	Qatar v Zimbabwe 1:2	4-2-3-1	1	0.70	8	66.7%
2025-10-14	Qatar v UAE 2:1	4-4-2	2	0.89	6	43.2%
2025-10-08	Oman v Qatar 0:0	4-4-2	0	0.60	12	69.2%

Qatar possession profile



Qatar phase emphasis



STRUCTURE INTERPRETATION

- Recent World Cup match used a 4-3-3 listed structure but defended long spells in a compact block.
- Qatar against Switzerland: 28.8% possession, 0.52 xG, 6 shots and 47% low-block phase.
- Attack is built around low-volume transition, Afif receiving freedom and direct release into wide/forward channels.
- Canada should move the block laterally before forcing central combinations.

47%

LOW BLOCK
out of possession

19%

ATTACKING TRANS.
phase share

49.17

PPDA
v Switzerland

GAME-FRAME ANALYSIS: QATAR BLOCK

Use the match photos as tactical evidence: central access is protected and the pressure cue often comes from a wide trigger.

1 MID-HIGH BLOCK ACCESS



- No.10 can press near the striker while the pivot line locks central passing lanes.
- Canada: do not force early central passes into the trap; move the block first.

2 WING PRESSURE TRIGGER



- Winger jumps from a narrower position toward the wide receiver as the back line holds cover.
- Canada: use third-man support and a quick switch to the far side.

DATA SUPPORT

294

42 direct PRESSURES

36

v Switzerland FORCED TO

47%

OPP phase LOW BLOCK

The data confirms a team willing to defend for long spells but still apply pressure once the ball is played into a trigger zone.

CANADA COACHING RESPONSE

- Keep the first pass secure after regain; do not invite Qatar into immediate counter-pressure.
- Move Qatar side-to-side, then attack before the second line resets.
- Use Buchanan/Millar as outlets rather than forcing central combinations too early.

GAME-FRAME ANALYSIS: TRANSITION THREAT

Qatar remain dangerous even with low chance volume: their front players can stay connected while the defensive unit protects depth.

1 FRONT UNIT CONNECTED



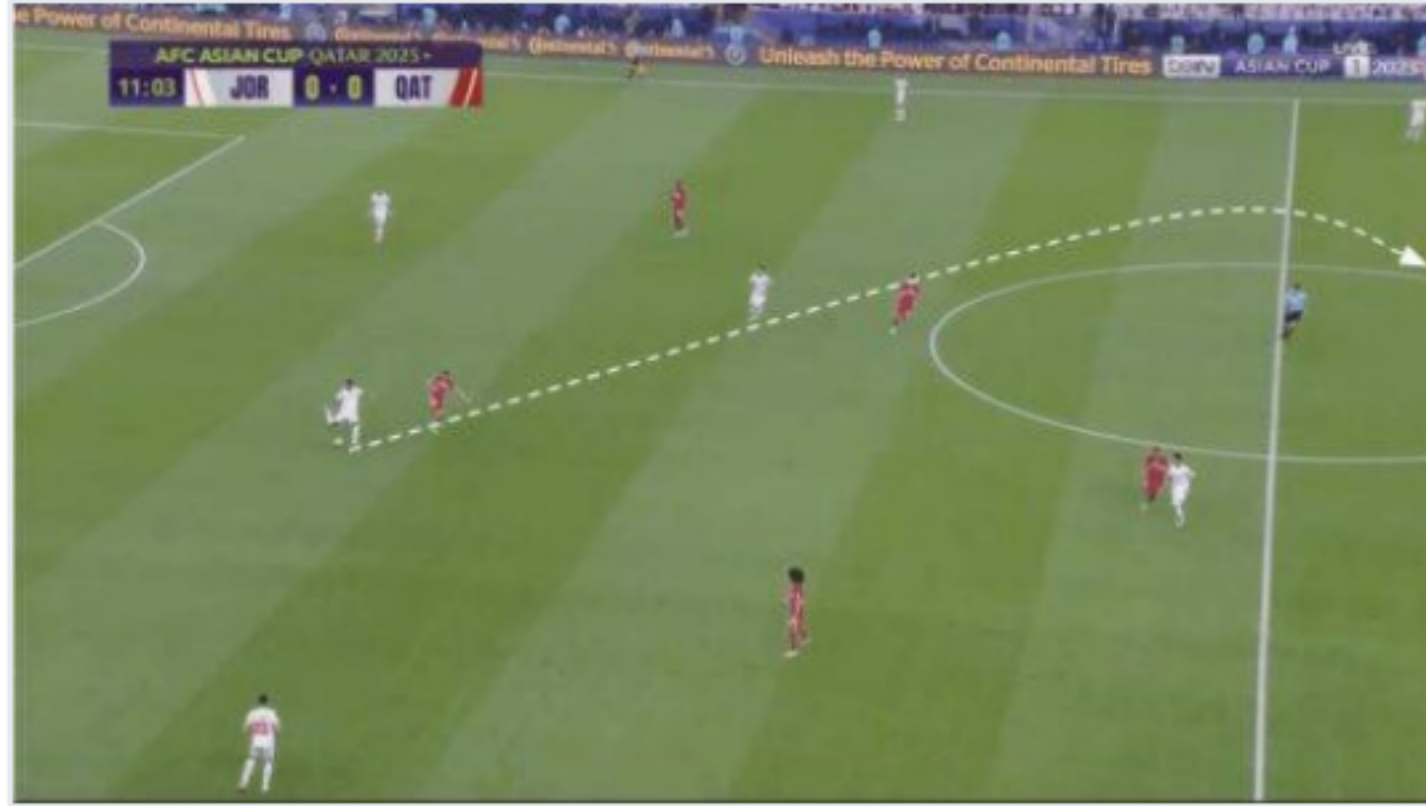
- The first forward pass can find a connected front line.
- Canada: protect the first pass after losing the ball.

2 DIRECT RELEASE CHANNEL



- Qatar can release into the wide channel once pressure is broken.
- Canada: rest defence must cover the weak side.

3 COUNTER FROM BLOCK



- The block protects depth, then attacks after a failed central pass.
- Canada: secure first contact and counter-press spacing.

ATTACKING QATAR

- Afif is the main release valve and can carry from the left/inside lane.
- Forward runs are usually direct rather than high-volume possession sequences.
- Substitutes can add running power if Qatar need a late transition threat.

DEFENDING THE TRANSITION

- Canada full-backs cannot both be high without cover.
- Eustáquio/Koné must screen the first pass into Afif/Ali zones.
- Force Qatar to restart rather than allowing the first forward carry.

KEY PLAYER PLAN: AKRAM AFIF

Qatar’s main attacking threat operates from the left/inside lane, drifts between lines and drives transitions. Canada must limit his first receive, deny the inside carry and force play away from his strongest combinations.

1

DENY THE FIRST RECEIVE



- Afif often drops off the left side to receive early and turn.
- Johnston stays tight while Buchanan protects the inside lane.
- Nearest midfielder screens the bounce pass into central support.

2

TRAP THE INSIDE CARRY



- He wants to carry from the left half-space onto his right foot.
- Show him outside and delay rather than diving into tackles.
- Do not open the channel between full-back and right centre-back.

3

CUT THE COMBINATION



- Afif links quickly with Almoez Ali and Al Haydos around the box.
- Canada’s second defender must arrive early to block the next pass.
- Force Qatar into slower circulation instead of direct release.

AFIF THREAT PROFILE

- Right-footed attacker who starts left but roams centrally.
- Primary transition outlet and best ball-carrier in open space.
- Can attract pressure, combine quickly and draw fouls in advanced areas.
- Danger increases when he receives on the half-turn facing goal.
- Set-piece influence adds extra value around the final third.

CANADA RESPONSE

- Johnston + Buchanan manage the first duel and the cover behind it.
- Eustaquio / Koné screen the inside pass and track his movement between lines.
- Rest defence must protect wide transition space if the ball is lost.
- Counter-press immediately after turnovers on Canada’s right side.
- Win the tactical battle by forcing Afif wide, backward and away from the box.

COACHING CUES

1

SHOW OUTSIDE

2

SCREEN INSIDE

3

DOUBLE EARLY

4

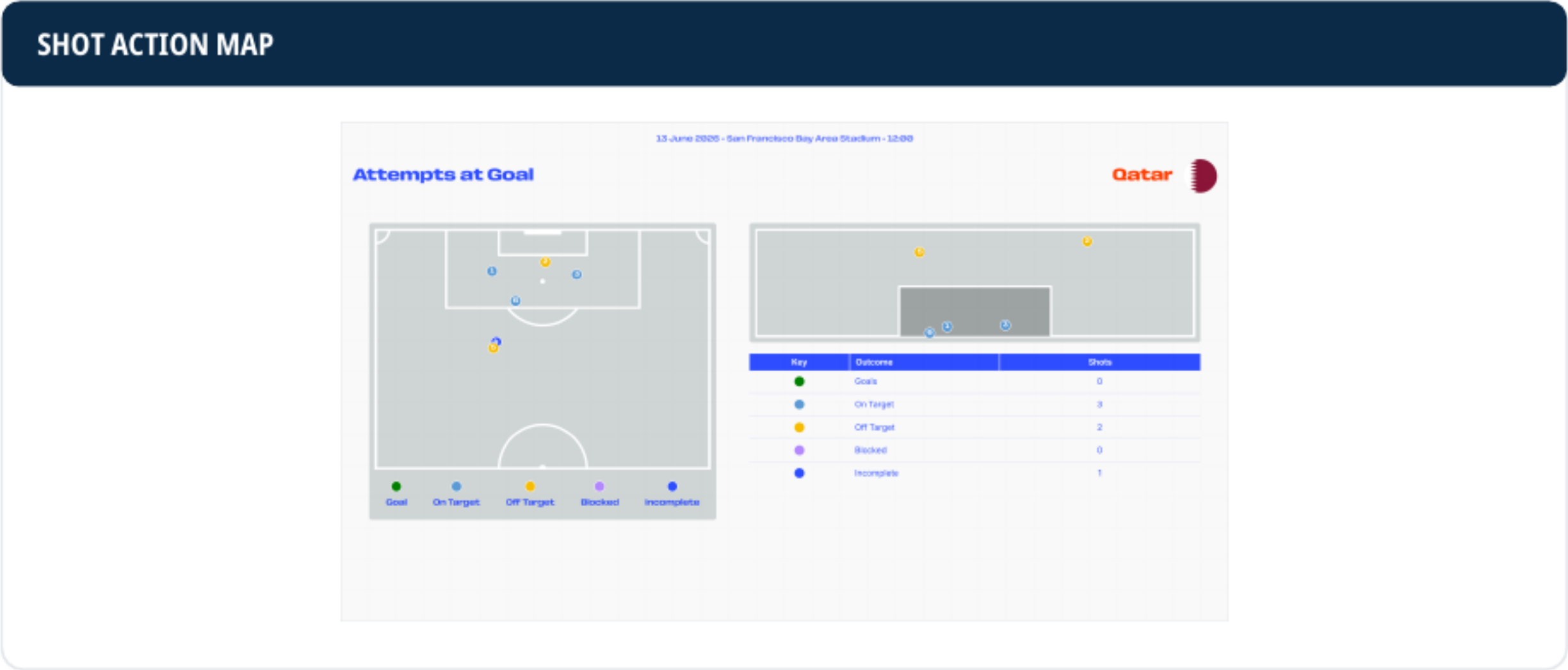
DELAY TRANSITION

5

NO CHEAP FOULS

FINISHING PROFILE: SHOT MAP & OUTPUT

Shot distribution confirms a low-volume opponent whose goal threat depends on transition, loose balls and isolated moments.

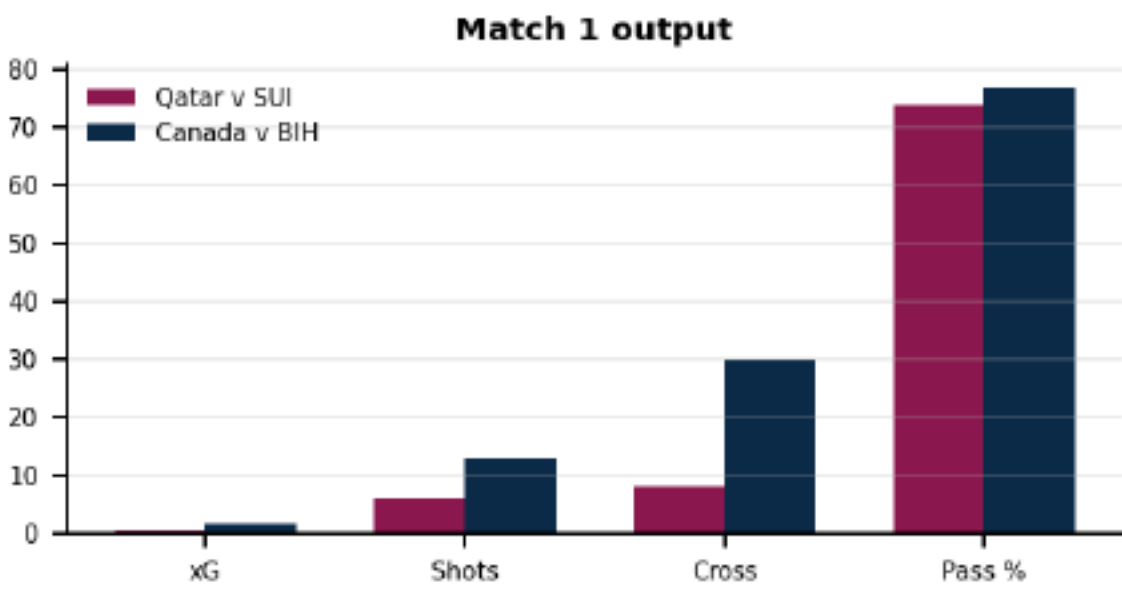


SHOT SOURCE TABLE

Source	Shots	SOT	xG	G
Total	6	3	0.52	1
Right foot/loose ball	2	2	-	0
Header from cross	1	0	-	0
Pass-created shot	2	1	-	0
Incomplete/error	1	0	-	0

ATTEMPT LIST

Min	Player	Outcome	Type
1	Edmilson Jr	Saved	Loose ball
29	Issa Laye	Off target	Cross/header
42	Edmilson Jr	Saved	Loose ball
43	Homam Ahmed	Incomplete	Loose ball
74	K. Boudiaf	Off target	Pass
89	A. Alaaeldin	Saved	Pass



DEFENSIVE ACTION MAPS & CANADA ATTACK ROUTES

Qatar defend through volume pressure, low-block time and wide pressing direction.



DEFENSIVE INDICATORS

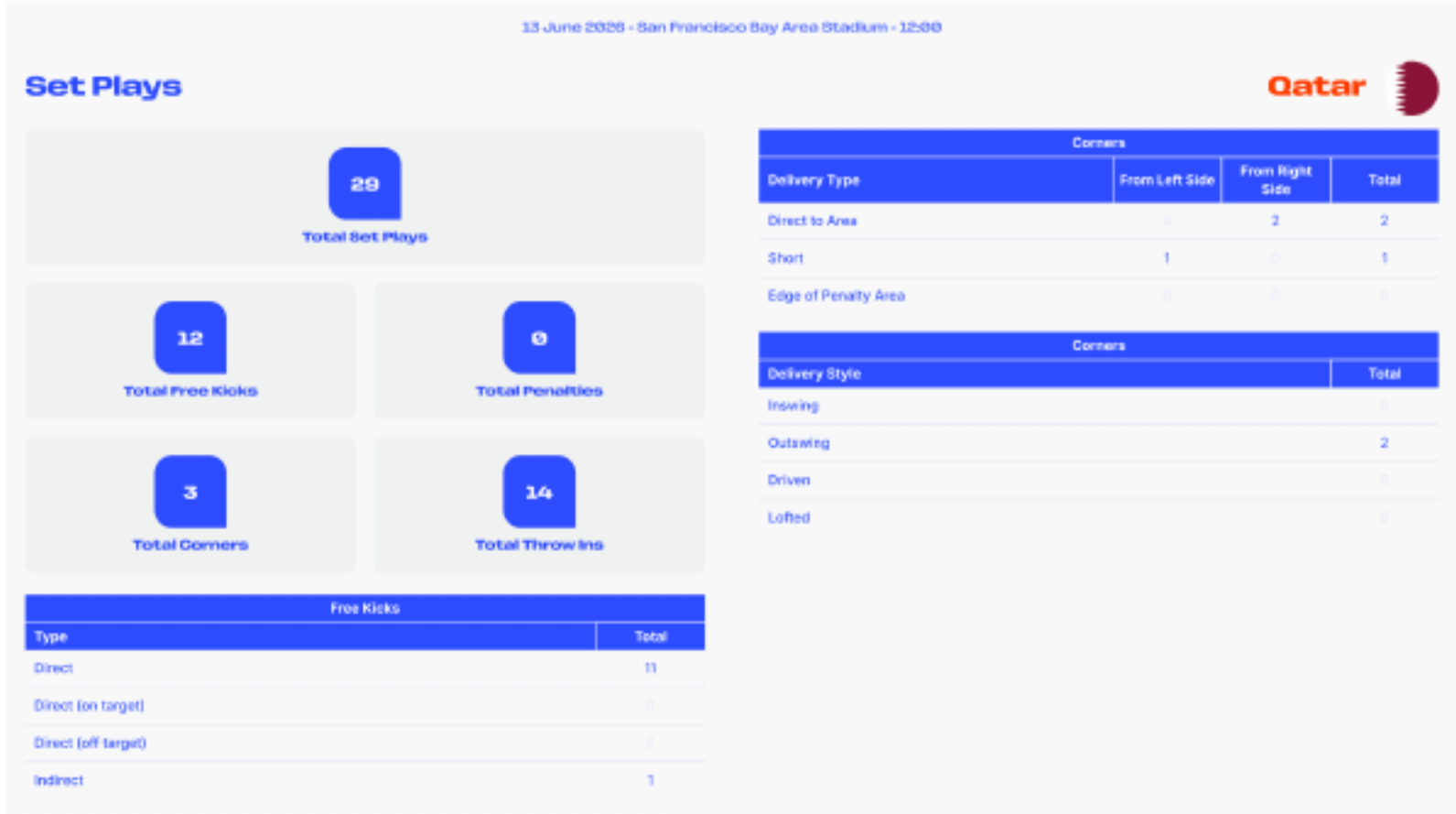
Metric	Qatar	Canada note
Total pressures	294	Expect traps
Direct pressures	42	Secure first pass
Forced turnovers	36	Avoid central risk
Low-block phase	47%	Move side-to-side
Aerial duels	23/11	Win second ball

- CANADA ROUTE MAP
- Move Qatar laterally, then isolate outside defenders before the back line resets.
 - Use David/Koné between lines to connect the first forward pass after regain.
 - Attack the channel behind advanced wide players, but hold one rest-defence player behind the ball.
 - Do not let Afif receive facing forward in the first counterattack lane.

SET PIECES: MAPS, TARGETS & GAME FRAME

Qatar set plays are not the primary threat, but corners and free-kick restarts can create second-ball chaos.

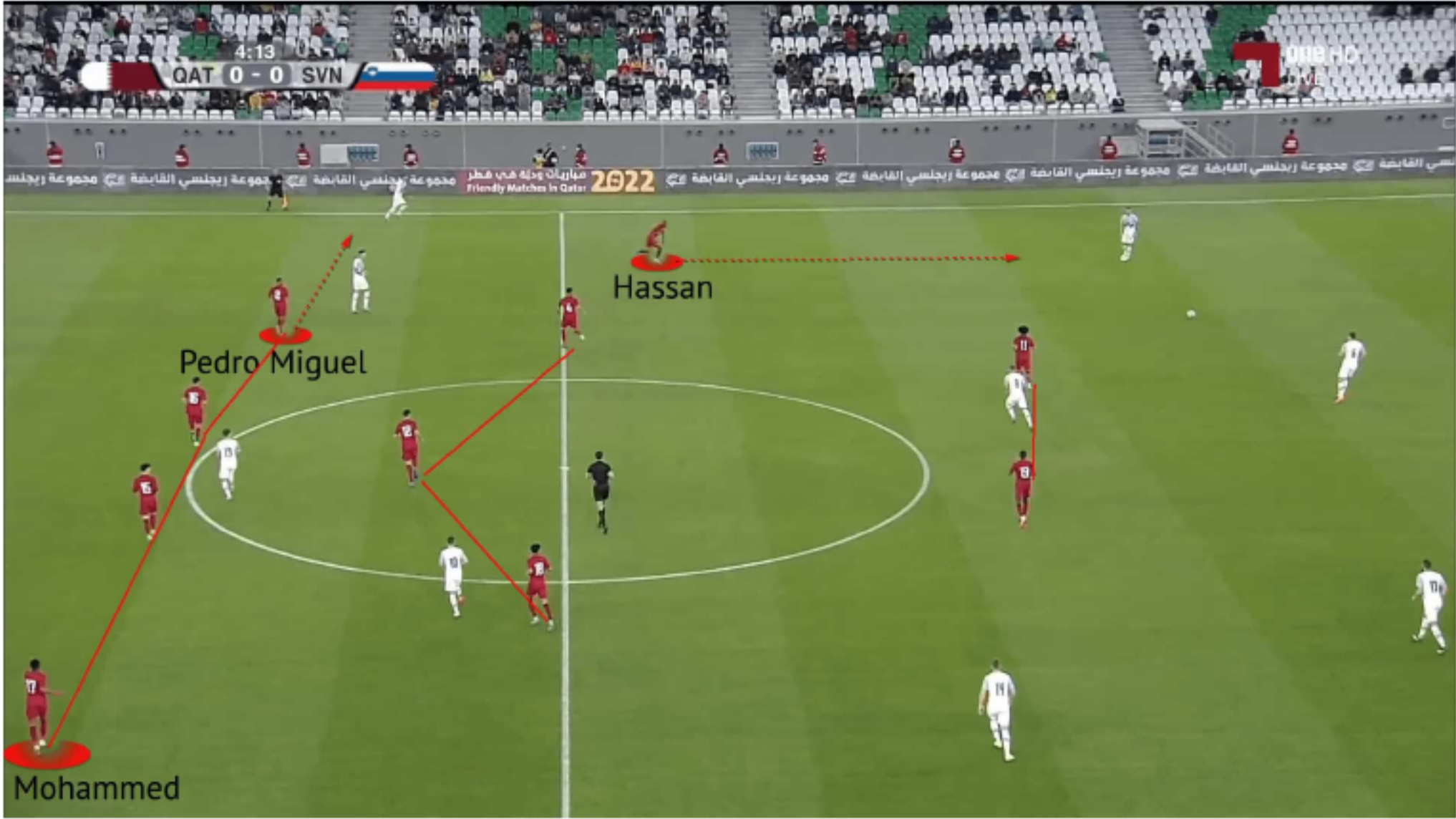
SET-PLAY PROFILE



RESTART PROFILE

Set play	Total	Note
Total set plays	29	12 free kicks
Corners	3	2 direct to area
Throw-ins	14	restarts to hold territory
Penalties	0	none in SUI match

GAME FRAME: SPACING MODEL



DEFENSIVE RULE

Canada need clean first contact, edge-zone protection and immediate counter outlets. Qatar do not need many entries to build pressure from repeat restarts.

CANADA MATCH PLAN

The plan connects match data, game-frame evidence and Qatar tactical tendencies into a match-day coaching sheet.

1. OUT OF POSSESSION

- Protect central-to-wide counter lanes after Canada attacks.
- Keep full-back/winger spacing balanced without Davies/Bombito recovery speed.
- Deny Afif first forward receive facing goal.
- Force Qatar into slower circulation rather than direct release.

2. IN POSSESSION

- Move Qatar side-to-side before attacking the half-space.
- Do not force central balls into the 4-2-3-1 screen.
- Use Buchanan/Johnston and Millar/Laryea as outlets after switches.
- David connects between lines; Larin pins the centre-backs.

3. SET PLAYS

- Win first contact and clear edge-zone rebounds.
- Prepare for short restarts and second-ball pressure.
- Counter if Qatar overcommit to the ball-side restart.

4. KEY MATCHUPS

- Johnston/Buchanan vs Homam/Afif-side release.
- Laryea/Millar vs Pedro Miguel/Ayoub Aloui side.
- Eustáquio/Koné vs Madibo/Khoukhi central screen.
- David vs the gap behind Qatar’s midfield line.

WINNING CONDITIONS

